

FORGE Phase 1 · Week 4 · Session 10 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 10: Understanding Trauma" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 10 as written runs the full 120 minutes, so the run of show adds no outside talk (an optional one is listed below). The two videos take about four minutes: the first stands in for your opening words, the second takes the first two minutes of the Instruction segment.

What's in this insert

- **Video 10A, "Understanding Trauma"** (2 min 2 s). The guide's opening words for the week: two things are true at the same time, anyone can step outside for a minute, no one will be forced to share what happened to him, and FORGE helps men understand trauma but does not treat it. It lists what today holds, states the week's message ("Trauma is not an excuse. It is an explanation."), and ends on the check-in question, held on screen for 20 seconds.
- **Video 10B, "Event, Experience, Effect"** (1 min 44 s). SAMHSA's Three E's on screen one at a time, "a normal human response to abnormal circumstances," and why survival strategies keep running after the danger is gone. It ends on "It keeps you responding to the past, even when you're living in the present."
- **No talk in the run of show.** This week is the heaviest in Phase 1, and the session as written already fills two hours. An optional talk for other times is listed below.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Opening Circle: Video 10A , then the check-in round	10	Play it as soon as the men are seated. It gives the week's opening words and ends on "How are you showing up today? What are you carrying into this room?" Add one thing the video cannot: who this week's mental health referral contact is. Then start the round.
0:10	Review & Reflection: emotion tracking patterns	10	As written.
0:20	Instruction, Part 1: What Trauma Actually Is	15	Play Video 10B first (2 minutes). Hand out the Three E's sheet after it, then give the guide's lines in your own voice and take questions.
0:35	Instruction, Part 2: ACEs	15	As written. The videos do not show the ten categories or any of the figures; they are yours to deliver.
0:50	Instruction, Part 3: Trauma Is Not an Excuse	10	As written. Video 10A has named the week's message; the car-alignment picture and the two men's sentences are yours.
1:00	Practice: Anonymous ACE Score Activity, with the 10-minute journal reflection	30	As written. The video has already told the men the paper is theirs and is not turned in; say it again when you hand it out.

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
1:30	Debrief & Discussion	20	As written.
1:50	Checkout & Assignment	10	As written.

A note on how the videos handle this material

The videos follow the guide's framing: trauma awareness without asking anyone to disclose. They show calm, reflective scenes and cards only. They never act out abuse, violence, self-harm or drug use, never show a child, and never ask a man to tell his story. Everything that names specific kinds of harm (the ten ACE categories and the research findings) stays with you and the handout, where you can watch the room while you say it.

If a man needs to step out during either video, let him go without comment. Video 10A tells him he can.

Optional talk (if time allows)

The session as written already runs two hours, so this talk is not in the run of show. Use it for a make-up session, when a segment runs short, or to prepare yourself before the session.

Nadine Burke Harris, *How childhood trauma affects health across a lifetime* (TED, 15 min 49 s). A pediatrician explains the ACE study, why severe childhood adversity can "get under our skin" and change the body, and the stress response ("fight that bear or run from the bear") that becomes a problem "when the bear comes home every night."

Preview note: she names the ten ACE categories, including sexual abuse, and cites a 12-times-higher risk of suicidality at four or more ACEs; she tells no stories of abuse and shows no graphic images.

Discussion questions:

1. She says severe adversity can "get under our skin" and change the body. How does that fit the third of the Three E's, the Effect?
2. The stress response that saves your life in front of a bear becomes a problem when it switches on "over and over and over again." How does that match what the guide says trauma does: keeps you responding to the past while you're living in the present?
3. She treats ACEs as a health problem, not a character flaw, and still expects action. How does that fit FORGE's line that trauma is not an excuse but an explanation?

- **YouTube** (TED's official channel): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=95ovIJ3dsNk>
- Also on TED.com: https://www.ted.com/talks/nadine_burke_harris_how_childhood_trauma_affects_health_across_a_lifetime

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nonprofit, no-fee, in-prison program. Show it whole and unedited, and check it against the facility's rules for outside media first.

Getting a copy you can play without internet

Download both MP4 files from forgementors.org/media.html and copy them to the playback device before the week starts. The room needs no internet connection. Play Video 10A once through with sound before the session.

Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 10A and 10B loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Mental health referral contact confirmed, so you can name it right after Video 10A
- ☐ Three E's handouts ready to give out right after Video 10B